

ACCIDENT CLAIMS SCOTLAND

Full SEO, AI Search, Legal Content and Conversion Audit

Revalidated 29 July 2026

Codebase, deployment configuration, public-search sample and authoritative-source review

Revalidation update — 29 July 2026

This update supersedes any conflicting finding in the 28 July audit reproduced after it. The full strategic, keyword, content, AI-search, competitor, schema, internal-linking and answer-block recommendations remain applicable unless expressly updated below.

Current release position

The codebase has materially improved since the original audit. Placeholder and unsupported regulatory-claim checks now pass; the enquiry form posts to a Cloudflare Worker that uses Resend; user-facing success and error states are truthful; the privacy notice names Ola Consultants Ltd as the recipient/controller;

LocalBusiness schema has been replaced with WebPage; the unsupported SearchAction has been removed; a skip link is present; the sitemap now includes location and road-traffic detail pages; Cloudflare Pages and Worker configuration are committed; and lint and TypeScript checks pass.

The site is still not ready to present itself as a Scottish personal-injury solicitor service without further verification. The About page says the website is an information resource and is not a regulated law firm, while titles, introductions, location descriptions and calls to action repeatedly promise or imply “our specialist solicitors”, “accident claims solicitors serving [city]”, and no-win-no-fee handling. The exact relationship between Ola Consultants Ltd, the website, any receiving solicitor practice, the referral/lead model, service acceptance, fees, and data sharing remains insufficiently explicit.

Revalidated top priorities

Priority	Current action	Severity	Owner
1	Reconcile the business model sitewide. If this is an information/referral service, replace “our solicitors” and “we handle” with accurate wording; name every receiving provider before transfer and explain selection, responsibility and remuneration.	Critical	Compliance + content
2	Verify Ola Consultants Ltd’s corporate identity, registered details, ICO position, lawful bases and special-category-data condition; publish the verified facts and retention schedule.	Critical	Privacy/compliance
3	Complete end-to-end form testing in production: CORS, Worker secret, Resend delivery, mailbox monitoring, incident alerts, spam/rate limiting, response SLA and deletion/retention.	Critical	Developer + operations

Priority	Current action	Severity	Owner
4	Prevent enquiries from being accepted when delivery or monitoring is unavailable; add a reference number and accessible focus movement to the success panel.	High	Developer
5	Obtain page-by-page review from a named Scottish personal-injury solicitor and replace organisational authorship with real accountable authors/reviewers where appropriate.	High	Solicitor + content
6	Rewrite no-win-no-fee content against the actual provider's written agreement. Remove categorical "no financial risk" language and explain success fees, VAT, outlays, insurance, adverse expenses and termination.	High	Solicitor/compliance
7	Noindex or consolidate city pages until each has distinct, evidenced local value; "serving" wording alone does not cure doorway-page risk.	High	SEO + content
8	Remove or merge same-intent guide/service duplicates identified in the URL map; implement 301 redirects and update internal links and sitemap entries.	High	SEO + developer
9	Replace blanket/future content dates with a verified publication and legal-review register. Update lastmod only after material review.	Medium	Content + developer
10	Establish measurement after lawful consent: Search Console, Bing Webmaster Tools, analytics, CRM/call outcomes and server/CDN logs.	High	Analytics + privacy

Confirmed changes since the original audit

Original issue	Revalidated status	Evidence
Placeholder data on production	Fixed in code	scripts/check-placeholders.mjs passes; siteConfig.ts contains no placeholder contact or regulator data
Simulated form success	Fixed in code, production delivery still requires operational proof	ClaimForm.tsx posts JSON to the Worker and shows success only on an OK response
No server-side validation/abuse controls	Partly fixed	workers/enquiry.js validates origin, required fields and lengths, includes a honeypot and sends through Resend; rate limiting and operational alerting are not demonstrated
Unnamed data controller	Partly fixed	Privacy page names Ola Consultants Ltd, but corporate/ICO details and the full Article 9 basis need verification
Fabricated LocalBusiness schema	Fixed	Location pages now emit WebPage schema without local addresses
Unsupported SearchAction	Fixed	WebSite schema no longer declares site search
Missing skip link	Fixed	Root layout includes "Skip to main content"
Missing sitemap dates/routes	Partly fixed	Static, location, guide and road-traffic detail URLs have lastModified; dates still need a verified editorial basis
Lint errors	Fixed	ESLint and TypeScript completed successfully on 29 July 2026
Build failure	Environment-limited, not a confirmed code defect	The production build reached Turbopack but the sandbox prevented a helper process binding to a port (EPERM)
Deployment unknown	Clarified in repository	wrangler.toml configures Cloudflare Pages static output; wrangler.enquiry.toml configures the enquiry Worker
Canonical host conflict	Code is internally consistent on www; live redirect/canonical behaviour still needs independent verification	SITE.url, robots.txt, sitemap and generated URLs use https://www.accident-claims-scotland.com

New or continuing confirmed issues

Finding	Status	Why it matters	Exact fix
Identity and proposition	Confirmed	About says information	Create one verified

Finding	Status	Why it matters	Exact fix
conflict		site/not a law firm; commercial templates imply the site's own solicitors and legal service	entity/service statement and apply it to titles, metadata, hero copy, forms, footer, legal pages and schema
No-win-no-fee wording is too categorical	Confirmed	"No financial risk" and "will not pay" statements may omit provider-specific exceptions, outlays, insurance and termination consequences	Use the actual written funding agreement; qualify every summary and identify the provider
Location pages remain highly templated	Confirmed	Doorway/thin-content risk persists despite safer schema	Noindex/merge until each page has genuine distinct usefulness and no false office implication
Organisational authorship without named legal reviewer	Confirmed	Weak YMYL accountability and AI trust	Add verified author/reviewer profiles, credentials, jurisdiction and real review dates
Metadata still describes "solicitors" as the site proposition	Confirmed	Search snippets can contradict the About disclosure	Rewrite root and route metadata to match the verified referral/information model
Form endpoint is cross-origin and publicly callable	Confirmed	Availability, abuse and privacy depend on the Worker configuration	Restrict allowed origins, rate-limit, log minimally, monitor delivery and publish processor/retention facts
Blanket sitemap lastModified date	Confirmed	Gives an unreliable freshness signal if pages were not substantively reviewed that day	Generate dates from a reviewed-content registry or source-control/content workflow
Search visibility not established	Confirmed from current public search sample	Exact-domain searches did not surface the target site in the sampled results	Submit/verify in GSC and Bing, inspect indexing/canonical selection, then prioritise content based on real query data

Live-search and legal-source note

Public search checks were repeated on 29 July 2026. The sampled results showed active Scottish competition from Winn Solicitors (Scotland), Scottish Accident, Lawford Kidd, Scottish Claims Helpline, Accident Claims Scotland .co.uk, Scotland Claims and other lead-generation/information sites. Exact searches for the target .com domain did not return the site in the sampled results; this is not proof of non-indexation and must be verified in Search Console and Bing Webmaster Tools.

Current legal review should continue to anchor limitation wording in sections 17–19A of the Prescription and Limitation (Scotland) Act 1973; funding in the Civil Litigation (Expenses and Group Proceedings) (Scotland) Act

2018 and the applicable success-fee regulations/agreement; CICA content in the current Criminal Injuries Compensation Scheme and official guidance; and procedural statements in current Scottish Courts and Tribunals Service rules and guidance. Nothing in this audit is individual legal advice.

Release recommendation

Keep the site in an information-only, carefully qualified state until the provider/referral model and operational enquiry handling are independently verified. Do not activate solicitor-led claims language merely because form delivery works. The commercially strongest next move is to establish a transparent, named and accountable service chain, then align every page, schema object and conversion step with that reality.

Original full audit — 28 July 2026

Audit date: 28 July 2026

Live check: 28 July 2026, approximately 14:00–15:00 BST

Codebase: /Users/rickgregory/Desktop/accident-claims-scotland

Live declared canonical: <https://accident-claims-scotland.com> (non-www)

Repository base URL: <https://www.accident-claims-scotland.com> (www) — this conflicts with the deployed canonical and sitemap/robots configuration

Scope: repository inspection, production rendering, live DOM checks, public search results, local build/lint checks and authoritative-source review.

Important: This is a marketing/content/technical audit, not legal advice. Every substantive legal statement must be approved by a suitably qualified Scottish solicitor before publication.

1. Executive summary

Current position

The site has a promising information architecture, a broad set of Scotland-specific service pages, useful direct-answer components, crawlable server-rendered content, breadcrumbs, a sitemap and a sizeable guide library. Its strongest strategic idea is to answer genuinely useful Scottish claimant questions instead of publishing only generic sales copy.

It is nevertheless **not safe or commercially ready in its present public state**. The production homepage presents the website as a regulated Scottish legal practice while publishing unresolved placeholders for the firm name, phone, email, office address, membership number, solicitor reviewer and review dates. The structured data repeats those placeholders. The enquiry form does not transmit an enquiry: it waits 800 ms and displays “Enquiry Received”. A potential claimant can therefore believe that sensitive legal/medical information has reached a regulated solicitor when it has not. This is the highest-priority trust, conversion and potential consumer/compliance risk.

The site’s owner, operator, controller, regulated provider and actual business model cannot be identified from the inspected live content or code. It is not possible to verify whether this is a law firm, a trading style, a marketing/referral service or a lead generator. Until those facts are supplied and independently verified, claims such as “our Scottish claims solicitors”, “regulated Scottish practice”, “solicitor-led claims”, “we handle” and “regulated by the Law Society of Scotland” are unsupported.

The content has good topical breadth but insufficient demonstrated expertise. Articles use future or unverified dates, have no named authors or reviewers, cite almost no primary sources, and make legal assertions across clinical negligence, industrial disease, fatal claims, offshore work, CICA and children’s claims without an accountable expert. AI systems can extract the copy, but they cannot reliably resolve who wrote it, who reviewed it, what entity stands behind it or why it should be trusted.

The ten city pages are largely generated from one template. Some city-specific wording exists, but most pages are too similar and do not prove offices, local teams, local casework or unique local usefulness. Their LegalService + LocalBusiness markup implies a local business in each place without a verified address. This creates material doorway-page and misleading-schema risk.

What the site does well

- Clear Scotland-wide subject and predominantly Scots-law terminology.
- Logical commercial pillars for personal injury, road traffic, work, public place, medical negligence, serious injury, industrial disease, CICA, compensation, process, limitation and funding.
- App Router pages render core text in HTML; only interactive components need client JavaScript.
- Useful answer boxes, TL;DR panels, FAQs, breadcrumbs and related-content modules.
- Descriptive, human-readable URLs and mostly one H1 per template.
- Sitemap and permissive robots.txt are present.
- No intrusive pop-up or observable third-party tracker was encountered in the rendered homepage check.
- Consent checkbox and privacy link appear on the enquiry form.
- Copy commonly qualifies outcomes and mentions evidence, liability and causation.

What is holding it back

1. Unverified identity and regulatory claims on a YMYL website.
2. A fake-success enquiry form that sends nothing.
3. Placeholder contact, complaints, privacy, author, review-date and schema data on production.
4. Location pages and local schema that imply unverified local operations.
5. Unsupported service-scope and funding claims.
6. No real solicitor authorship, review trail, credentials or source citations.
7. Overlapping guide and service-page intents.
8. Repetitive location and service templates with limited original evidence.
9. Global metadata supplies a homepage canonical to pages that do not override it; current pages mostly override it, but this is fragile.
10. Technical QA is failing: ESLint reports 26 errors.

Trust verdict

No. An injured person should not be asked to trust this site until the operator, legal provider, regulatory status, data controller, contact routes, fee model, complaints path and form delivery are all real, visible and verified. The visual design looks plausible, but the unresolved placeholders and unsupported regulatory assertions undermine it immediately.

Can search and AI systems identify the essential entities?

Entity/fact	Verdict	Evidence
Website owner/operator	No	No verified legal entity in siteConfig.ts, About, footer or legal pages
Regulated provider	No	[LAW FIRM NAME] and [Law Society of Scotland Membership Number]
Service/referral model	No	Copy alternates between "our solicitors", "claims service" and "practice"
Jurisdiction	Partly	Scotland and Scots law are stated, but cross-border limits are not consistently defined
Claim types	Yes, as assertions	Clear navigation and pages, but actual provider scope is unverified

Entity/fact	Verdict	Evidence
Authors/reviewers	No	[SOLICITOR NAME] and [DATE]
Contact details/location	No	Placeholder phone, email and address
Funding/fees	Partly	General explanation exists; actual agreement, deductions, outlays and provider terms are unknown
Eligibility/deadlines/process	Partly	Strong discoverability, but several summaries oversimplify limitation and special routes

Top 10 actions

Priority	Action	Impact	Effort	Owner
1	Immediately take the public site out of lead-generation mode: disable forms and unsupported regulated/legal-service assertions or place the site behind a noindex maintenance page until verified facts are supplied.	Critical compliance/trust	Low	Compliance + developer
2	Verify and publish operator, data controller, legal provider, regulator/membership link, registered address, real phone/email, service model and geographic scope.	Critical compliance/conversion /AI	Medium	Directors + solicitor
3	Replace simulated form success with secure delivery, server-side validation, spam protection, logging, error recovery and a truthful acknowledgement. Test end to end.	Critical conversion/data	Medium	Developer + operations
4	Have a Scottish personal-injury solicitor review every legal/service page; add named	High trust/SEO/AI	High	Solicitor + content

Priority	Action	Impact	Effort	Owner
	author/reviewer profiles, credentials, dates and material source citations.			
5	Remove all placeholder and future/unverified dates from live HTML and JSON-LD; prevent deployment when placeholder tokens remain.	High trust/quality	Low	Developer
6	Remove LocalBusiness schema from city pages and noindex most city pages until each has verifiable, distinct value. Never imply an office that does not exist.	High SEO/compliance	Low	SEO + developer
7	Consolidate overlapping guide/service intents, especially limitation, road traffic, accident at work, no-win-no-fee and compensation.	High SEO/AI	Medium	SEO + content
8	Rewrite limitation, CICA, fatal-claim, medical-negligence, industrial-disease and funding content against primary sources; distinguish raising court proceedings from merely contacting a solicitor.	High legal/trust	High	Solicitor
9	Fix lint errors; add CI checks for build, lint, broken links, placeholder tokens, schema and sitemap/canonical consistency.	Medium technical	Medium	Developer
10	After relaunch, connect Search Console, Bing Webmaster Tools, GA4 (or privacy-respecting analytics), consent,	High measurement	Medium	Analytics + privacy

Priority	Action	Impact	Effort	Owner
	CRM and call tracking with documented events and retention rules.			

2. Confirmed findings and access-dependent checks

Confirmed findings

Finding	Status	Evidence	Severity
Host/canonical signals conflict	Confirmed	Requested/live browser URL remained https://www.accident-claims-scotland.com/ , while homepage declared canonical and og:url as https://accident-claims-scotland.com ; About and Glasgow also canonically declare non-www; repository SITE.url, sitemap and robots use www	High
Placeholder phone is visible and linked	Confirmed	Live header/hero; src/data/siteConfig.ts:5; ClaimForm.tsx:43-45	Critical
Unsupported Law Society regulation statements are public	Confirmed	Live header, hero and footer; siteConfig.ts; page.tsx; no firm/member identity supplied	Critical
Form does not send data but reports success	Confirmed	ClaimForm.tsx:25-30: timeout followed by setSubmitted(true); no API call	Critical
Placeholder firm/address/email/member data are emitted in organisation schema	Confirmed	src/lib/schema.ts:3-49 plus siteConfig.ts	Critical
City pages emit LocalBusiness without a verified local address	Confirmed	localBusinessSchema() and LocationPageTemplate.tsx	High
Published/reviewed dates and solicitor names are placeholders	Confirmed	Claim template and location template; legal pages also contain [DATE]	High
Core content is server-rendered/static-capable	Confirmed	Next.js App Router server components; client boundary limited to form/header/FAQ; live DOM contains full text	Positive

Finding	Status	Evidence	Severity
Framework is Next.js 16.2.9 / React 19.2.4	Confirmed	package.json; App Router under src/app	Informational
Deployment is consistent with Vercel but not proven	Inference	Vercel response behaviour/assets and README; no vercel.json or hosting configuration in repository	Low
Sitemap contains all service, location, guide and legal routes	Confirmed	src/app/sitemap.ts; live sitemap endpoint configured	Positive
Static sitemap pages omit lastModified	Confirmed	Only guides receive lastModified; service/legal/location pages do not	Low
robots.txt allows all crawlers	Confirmed	public/robots.txt	Positive/monitor
SearchAction points to a non-existent search function	Confirmed	schema.ts points to /guides?search=...; guides page has no demonstrated search feature	Medium
Lint fails	Confirmed	26 react/no-unescaped-entities errors on 28 July 2026	Medium
The repository has extensive uncommitted work	Confirmed	git status --short shows most routes/components untracked plus modified core files	Medium deployment risk
Location content is heavily templated	Confirmed	Ten pages use LocationPageTemplate; eight are ~363 source words and share near-identical copy/FAQs	High
No Open Graph image is configured	Confirmed	Root metadata has OG/Twitter text but no image; no route OG image file	Medium
Site uses no content images beyond icons/emoji in inspected routes	Confirmed	Public assets are starter SVGs/favicon; content is text/emoji	Low performance, medium credibility

Access-dependent checks

System	Required report/evidence	Decision informed
Google Search Console	Page indexing, sitemap status, canonical selected by Google, crawl stats, HTTPS, manual actions/security, Core Web Vitals, search results by page/query/device/country, links	Which URLs are indexed; cannibalisation; real query demand; CWV priorities; penalties

System	Required report/evidence	Decision informed
Bing Webmaster Tools	Index Explorer, Site Scan, crawl errors, search keywords/pages, backlinks, IndexNow status	Bing indexation and technical defects; whether IndexNow is worthwhile
GA4/analytics	Landing pages, engaged sessions, form-start/form-error/form-success/call/email events, device, source/medium, consent state	Conversion funnel, mobile friction, content value, paid/organic quality
Consent platform	Cookie inventory, categories, default state, consent logs, tag firing before/after choice, withdrawal	PECR/UK GDPR compliance and whether analytics data is lawful/reliable
CRM/form system	Test submissions with timestamps, field mapping, delivery logs, duplicate/spam handling, acknowledgement, response SLA, lawful-basis/retention records	Whether enquiries arrive and receive appropriate handling
Call tracking	Number ownership, dynamic-number insertion, consent, recordings, missed calls, qualification/outcomes	Phone conversion and privacy risk
Server/CDN logs	Bot/user-agent requests, status codes, cache hits, 404s, query parameters, staging hosts	Crawl waste, soft 404s, AI crawler access, caching and unwanted hosts
Hosting/deployment	Vercel/project ownership, production domains, preview deployment protection, environment variables, deployment history, rollback, headers	Confirm host, stop preview indexation, secure secrets and forms
Backlink tool	Referring domains/pages, anchors, lost links, toxic/manual patterns, competitor link intersections	Digital PR priorities; do not infer authority without it
Rank tracker	Agreed Scotland/UK location, mobile/desktop, exact query set, SERP features	Baseline share of voice and whether city pages merit investment
Email system	SPF, DKIM, DMARC, inbound alias, ticketing/CRM routing and monitored mailbox	Form acknowledgement/delivery reliability and impersonation risk

3. Technical SEO, accessibility and performance

Finding	Status	Evidence/affected area	Why it matters	Severity	Exact fix	Impact	Owner
Public YMYL pages contain placeholders	Confirmed	Sitewide templates, legal pages, schema	Destroys trust; may mislead users/crawlers	Critical	Block deployment on regex \[[A-Z][^]]+\]; replace only	Trust/compliance/SEO	Developer + compliance

Finding	Status	Evidence/ affected area	Why it matters	Severity	Exact fix	Impact	Owner
					with verified facts; otherwise noindex/maintenance		
Form gives false success	Confirmed	ClaimForm.tsx	Lost claims and potentially missed deadlines	Critical	POST to secure server action/API; persist correlation ID; show success only after accepted response; show recoverable error; alert ops on failure	Conversion/compliance	Developer
No server-side form validation or abuse protection	Confirmed	Client-only required; no endpoint	Data quality/security	High	Validate/sanitise server-side, rate-limit, honeypot or privacy-safe CAPTCHA, CSRF/origin checks, size limits	Security/conversion	Developer
Legal/medical free-text has no explicit special-category handling	Confirmed	Form asks injuries/incident	Health data is likely; privacy notice is generic	High	Name controller/processors/recipients, purpose, lawful basis and Article 9 condition as applicable; minimise fields; define retention and rights	Compliance	Privacy counsel
LocalBusiness schema fabricates local presence	Confirmed	All ten city routes	Misleading entity/local signals	High	Remove LocalBusiness/address; use WebPage + Service with	SEO/compliance	Developer + SEO

Finding	Status	Evidence/ affected area	Why it matters	Severity	Exact fix	Impact	Owner
					areaServed only if genuine; add office only where staffed and verifiable		
Organisation schema fabricates facts	Confirmed	Sitewide JSON-LD	Entity confusion and trust risk	Critical	Suppress organisation/ legal-service markup until verified; then use one stable @id and exact legal name	AI/SEO/trust	Developer
SearchAction is not supported by site search	Confirmed	webSiteSche ma()	Invalid/ misleading action	Medium	Remove until a working search results experience exists	Schema	Developer
FAQ schema is emitted broadly	Confirmed	Service/ location templates	Google FAQ rich results are generally restricted and schema adds little when generic	Low	Keep only where questions/an swers are visible and useful; do not measure success by rich results; omit from repetitive local pages	SEO	SEO
Canonical host conflicts with browser URL, repository and sitemap	Confirmed	Live canonical is non-www; browser stayed on www; repository/si temap/robot s use www	Splits indexing/link signals and indicates deployed source/confi g drift	High	Select one host after DNS/hosting review (recommend the host with established links); 308 every alternate in one hop; use it in metadataBas e, canonicals, OG, sitemap	Crawl	Developer

Finding	Status	Evidence/ affected area	Why it matters	Severity	Exact fix	Impact	Owner
					and robots		
Redirect matrix not verifiable from restricted shell	Access required	HTTP/www/case/slash variants	Duplicate URLs/chain risk	Medium	Test at edge and document single-hop 308 rules	SEO	Developer
Static sitemap lacks meaningful modification dates	Confirmed	sitemap.ts	Weak recrawl signal; fake dates are worse	Low	Add dates from a real reviewed-content registry/deployment record; never use current build time	SEO	Developer/content
Future/unverified article dates	Confirmed	All guides use modified 2026-06-01 regardless of review evidence	Freshness manipulation risk	High	Store actual publication/review dates per article and reviewer; update only for substantive change	Trust/AI	Content/compliance
No social image	Confirmed	Root metadata	Poor previews and weaker sharing/brand credibility	Medium	Add verified branded opengraph-image and Twitter image; 1200x630; meaningful alt	Conversion	Design/developer
No content imagery or proof assets	Confirmed	Sitewide	Limits trust and accessibility context, though it keeps pages light	Medium	Add authentic team/provider/process visuals only; optimise dimensions/AVIF/WebP; avoid stock "injured person" clichés	Trust/conversion	Design

Finding	Status	Evidence/ affected area	Why it matters	Severity	Exact fix	Impact	Owner
Navigation dropdown/button depends on JS	Confirmed	Header.tsx client component	Core links may be less robust without JS	Medium	Render an accessible <details> or CSS-capable fallback; preserve server-rendered links in DOM	Accessibility/crawl	Developer
FAQ accordion depends on JS	Confirmed	FAQ.tsx	Answers may exist in DOM but interaction must be keyboard/AT robust	Low	Prefer native <details><summary>; test focus, expanded state and headings	Accessibility	Developer
Emoji used as interface/claim icons	Confirmed	Claim cards and template sidebars	Inconsistent rendering/noisy AT names	Low	Use decorative SVGs with aria-hidden=true; retain textual labels	Accessibility/design	Developer
Sticky mobile CTA may obscure content	Inference	MobileSticky Cta fixed layout	Common WCAG/mobile issue	Medium	Test 320 px width, 200% zoom, landscape and virtual keyboard; add bottom content padding and dismiss option if needed	Accessibility/conversion	Design/dev
Form confirmation is not announced	Inference	Conditional render, no live region/focus management	Screen-reader users may miss result	Medium	Move focus to result heading; role=status/appropriate live region; preserve entered data on error	Accessibility	Developer
No skip-link implementation demonstrate	Inference	main id="main-content" exists, but no	Keyboard navigation	Medium	Add first-focusable "Skip to main content" link	Accessibility	Developer

Finding	Status	Evidence/ affected area	Why it matters	Severity	Exact fix	Impact	Owner
d		skip link found in inspected header					
Lint failure	Confirmed	26 errors	Weak release discipline	Medium	Fix JSX entity errors; make lint/build mandatory in CI	Quality	Developer
Google font fetched through next/font	Confirmed	layout.tsx	Usually self- hosted by build, but build environment s need font retrieval/cac he	Low	Pin/cache build; consider local font if repeatable builds fail	Performance	Developer
No observable images causing LCP bloat	Confirmed	Homepage	Positive	—	Keep hero text-first; measure real LCP before adding assets	Performance	Design
Actual CWV unavailable	Access required	Field data needed	Lab estimates are not user experience	High	Use GSC CrUX + PageSpeed/L ighthouse for representativ e templates; prioritise field LCP/INP/CLS	Performance	Developer
404 component exists	Confirmed	not- found.tsx	Positive, but status/soft-4 04 needs live test	Low	Verify unknown URLs return 404, are not canonicalise d to home, and have noindex if desired	SEO	Developer
Preview/ staging indexation unknown	Access required	No deployment config	Duplicate environment risk	High	Password/ protect previews; X- Robots-Tag: noindex; audit Search Console host	SEO	DevOps

Finding	Status	Evidence/ affected area	Why it matters	Severity	Exact fix	Impact	Owner
					variants		
Security headers unknown	Access required	Browser DOM is not a full edge-header audit	Trust/security	Medium	Check CSP, HSTS, Referrer-Policy, Permissions-Policy, nosniff, frame-ancestors	Security	Developer

Framework, rendering and deployment

- **Framework:** Next.js 16.2.9, React 19.2.4, TypeScript, Tailwind CSS 4.
- **Router/rendering:** App Router. Most pages are server components and statically renderable. Dynamic guides use `generateStaticParams`, so core guide content can be pre-rendered. Header, FAQ and form are client components.
- **Metadata:** Next.js Metadata API with a root `metadataBase` and route-level canonicals.
- **Deployment:** The production host is live and behaviour is consistent with Vercel, but the repository has no deployment manifest and this cannot be confirmed without platform access.
- **Caching:** No explicit caching or revalidation strategy is configured. Static content should be cached by the framework/platform; verify production headers and purge behaviour.
- **Next.js-specific recommendation:** keep factual metadata co-located with reviewed content, use metadata files for robots/sitemap/OG imagery, and do not emit schema facts that are not visible and verified.

4. Keyword, intent and URL map

No reliable first-party volume data was supplied. The labels below are **intent classifications, not volume claims**. Current search results show active competition from Winn Solicitors Scotland, Scotland Claims, Accident Claims Scotland .co.uk, Scottish Accident, Stewart Legal, Gildeas, Slater and Gordon and specialist Scottish firm pages. Validate demand in Search Console, Ads Keyword Planner or a licensed tool before expanding.

Major indexable pages

Current URL	Action	Primary intent/keyword	Supporting entities	Recommended title	Recommended H1	Missing/next sections	Cannibalisation/internal links
/	Keep after identity fix	accident claims Scotland; mixed commercial	Scottish personal injury solicitor, claim check	Accident Claims Scotland: Scottish Personal Injury	Accident Claims in Scotland: Speak to a Verified Scottish	Verified provider, who receives enquiry, eligibility triage,	Link to every pillar; avoid duplicating full PI pillar

Current URL	Action	Primary intent/key word	Supporting entities	Recommended title	Recommended H1	Missing/next sections	Cannibalisation/internal links
				Solicitors	Personal Injury Solicitor	funding summary, reviewer	
/personal-injury-claims-scotland	Expand/review	personal injury claims Scotland	negligence, causation, evidence, solatium	Personal Injury Claims Scotland: Eligibility, Process and Funding	Personal Injury Claims in Scotland	Clear elements of claim, special cases, provider proof, sources	Canonical pillar; guides link here
/road-traffic-accident-claims-scotland	Keep/expand	road traffic accident claims Scotland	car, motorcycle, cycling, pedestrian, MIB, whiplash	Road Traffic Accident Claims Scotland: A Practical Guide	Road Traffic Accident Claims in Scotland	MIB/ uninsured/ untraced, evidence, insurer contact, cross-border	Merge/ reposition same-intent RTA guide
/accident-at-work-claims-scotland	Keep/expand	accident at work claim Scotland	employer duty, RIDDOR, HSE, PPE	Accident at Work Claims Scotland: Rights, Evidence and Process	Accident at Work Claims in Scotland	Employment reassurance carefully qualified, evidence preservation, HSE sources	Merge/ reposition same-intent guide
/public-place-accident-claims-scotland	Keep/expand	public place accident claims Scotland	occupiers' liability, council, supermarket, slip/trip	Public Place Accident Claims Scotland	Claims for Accidents in Public Places in Scotland	Occupier/ council distinctions; notice/CCTV; defensible case examples	Support with slip/supermarket/council guides
/medical-negligence-claims-scotland	Keep; solicitor rewrite	medical negligence claims Scotland	clinical negligence, NHS board, breach, causation	Medical Negligence Claims Scotland: What Must Be Proved	Medical Negligence Claims in Scotland	Complaints vs damages, expert evidence, consent, causation, CLO terminology, sources	Hub for GP/NHS/birth/cancer/etc
/serious-injury-claims-scotland	Keep; split fatal section if offered	serious injury claims Scotland	brain, spinal, amputation, rehabilitation	Serious Injury Claims Scotland: Compensation and Rehabilitation	Serious Injury Claims in Scotland	Interim payments qualified, rehabilitation code, future loss, capacity	Link fatal guide; consider fatal pillar only with genuine service

Current URL	Action	Primary intent/key word	Supporting entities	Recommended title	Recommended H1	Missing/next sections	Cannibalisation/internal links
/industrial-disease-claims-scotland	Keep; solicitor rewrite	industrial disease claims Scotland	mesothelioma, NIHL, HAVS, historic employer	Industrial Disease Claims Scotland: Exposure, Evidence and Time Limits	Industrial Disease and Occupational Illness Claims in Scotland	Insurer tracing, medical/exposure proof, statutory schemes distinction	Hub for asbestos/NIHL/HAVS
/criminal-injury-compensation-scotland	Keep; rewrite	CICA claims Scotland	2012 Scheme, crime of violence, tariff, police report	CICA Claims Scotland: Eligibility, Time Limits and Awards	Criminal Injury Compensation (CICA) Claims in Scotland	Make civil/CICA distinction prominent; two-year rule; conduct/convictions; tariff; review/appeal	Never blend three-year civil deadline into CICA content
/personal-injury-compensation-scotland	Keep; legal review	personal injury compensation Scotland	solatium, past/future loss, care, earnings	Personal Injury Compensation in Scotland: What Can Be Claimed?	Personal Injury Compensation in Scotland	Valuation evidence, interest/tax caveats, examples only if sourced	Merge “what is my claim worth” guide or make it methodology-only
/how-to-claim-compensation-scotland	Keep	how to claim compensation Scotland	enquiry, investigation, medical report, negotiation, court	How to Claim Compensation in Scotland: The Personal Injury Process	How to Make a Personal Injury Claim in Scotland	Who handles each step, response expectations, alternatives, court routes	Process pillar; link evidence/court guides
/personal-injury-claim-time-limits-scotland	Keep; authoritative rewrite	personal injury claim time limit Scotland	1973 Act ss17, 18, 19A; date of knowledge	Personal Injury Time Limits in Scotland: The Three-Year Rule	Personal Injury Claim Time Limits in Scotland	“Raise proceedings” wording, statutory knowledge test, discretion not guarantee, special routes	Merge same-intent guide; retain one canonical
/no-win-no-fee-solicitors-scotland	Keep only after terms verified	no win no fee solicitors Scotland	success fee agreement, deductions, outlays, insurance	No Win No Fee in Scotland: Costs, Deductions	How No Win No Fee Personal Injury Claims Work in	Actual provider agreement, cap/percentage, VAT,	Merge same-intent guide

Current URL	Action	Primary intent/key word	Supporting entities	Recommended title	Recommended H1	Missing/next sections	Cannibalisation/internal links
				and Risks	Scotland	outlays, ATE, termination, adverse expenses	
/guides	Keep	Scottish personal injury guides	topic hubs, authors, reviewed dates	Scottish Personal Injury Guides	Scottish Personal Injury Guides Reviewed by Scottish Solicitors	Category navigation, author/reviewer, methodology, search only if real	Link guides to pillars and vice versa
/about	Replace placeholders /expand	about Accident Claims Scotland	owner, firm, solicitors, regulator	About Accident Claims Scotland and the Legal Provider	Who Operates Accident Claims Scotland?	Exact legal roles, firm/team profiles, membership links, locations, editorial policy	Primary entity page
/contact	Keep after form fix	contact personal injury solicitor Scotland	callback, phone, email, accessibility	Contact Accident Claims Scotland	Make a Confidential Initial Enquiry	Who receives data, response time, urgent/deadline warning, accessible channels	CTA destination
Legal pages	Keep; noindex terms/accessibility only if strategy demands	navigational/compliance	controller, cookies, complaints, accessibility	Accurate descriptive titles	Plain H1	Verified entities/dates/processes	Footer links; generally indexable is acceptable

City/location pages

URLs	Current action	Primary intent if retained	Uniqueness requirement
/glasgow-accident-claims, /edinburgh-accident-claims	Noindex until verified; later Keep only if evidence supports	personal injury solicitor Glasgow/Edinburgh	Real provider coverage, named nearest office/team or clear remote model, local court/health/transport context used helpfully, unique local FAQs, genuine cases/testimonials only with consent and evidence

URLs	Current action	Primary intent if retained	Uniqueness requirement
/aberdeen-accident-claims	Noindex; potentially expand	accident claims Aberdeen	Offshore expertise must be genuinely offered and evidenced; no invented office
/dundee-accident-claims, /inverness-accident-claims, /stirling-accident-claims, /perth-accident-claims, /paisley-accident-claims, /ayr- accident-claims, /falkirk- accident-claims	Noindex or merge to one Scotland service-area page	local navigational intent	Retain only where page adds material claimant value beyond replacing a city name; otherwise doorway risk

Recommended local title pattern, only when justified: Personal Injury Solicitors Serving Glasgow | [Verified Firm].

Recommended H1: Personal Injury Claims for People in Glasgow. “Serving” avoids implying an office.

Guide inventory: keyword-to-URL map and action

Guide slug	Primary intent	Action/parent
personal-injury-claim-time-limit-scotland	how long to claim in Scotland	Merge/301 to time-limit pillar
accident-at-work-claim-scotland	can I claim after work accident	Merge or reposition as eligibility guide; parent work pillar
evidence-for-personal-injury-claim-scotland	evidence needed	Keep; parent PI/process
medical-negligence-what-to-prove-scotland	what must be proved	Keep; parent medical
nhs-negligence-claims-scotland-explained	NHS negligence process	Keep after expert review; parent medical
industrial-disease-delayed-symptoms-scotland	delayed symptoms/date of knowledge	Keep; parent industrial
what-is-my-accident-claim-worth-scotland	claim value	Merge or narrow to valuation methodology; parent compensation
can-i-claim-if-partly-at-fault-scotland	contributory negligence	Keep; parent PI
what-if-liability-denied-scotland	disputed liability	Keep; parent PI/process
do-i-need-to-go-to-court-scotland	court attendance	Keep; parent process
road-traffic-accident-claims-scotland	RTA claims	Merge/301 to RTA pillar
whiplash-claims-scotland	whiplash Scotland	Keep; parent RTA
construction-accident-claims-scotland	construction injury	Keep only if offered; parent work
asbestos-claims-scotland	asbestos disease claim	Keep with specialist review; parent industrial
noise-induced-hearing-loss-claims-scotland	NIHL claim	Keep; parent industrial

Guide slug	Primary intent	Action/parent
gp-negligence-claims-scotland	GP negligence	Keep if offered; parent medical
birth-injury-claims-scotland	birth injury claim	Keep only with genuine expertise; parent medical
serious-injury-rehabilitation-scotland	rehabilitation in serious claims	Keep; parent serious
fatal-accident-compensation-scotland	fatal claim Scotland	Keep if offered; parent serious or future fatal pillar
slip-trip-fall-claims-scotland	slip/trip claim	Keep; parent public place
supermarket-accident-claims-scotland	supermarket accident	Keep if distinct evidence advice; parent public place
council-pavement-trip-claims-scotland	council pavement claim	Keep after legal correction/review; parent public place
offshore-injury-claims-scotland	offshore injury claim	Keep only with verified jurisdictional expertise; parent work
vibration-white-finger-claims-scotland	HAVS/VWF claim	Keep; parent industrial
care-home-negligence-claims-scotland	care-home negligence	Keep only if service scope clear; may involve different legal theories; parent medical/PI
prescription-error-claims-scotland	prescription error	Keep; parent medical
cancer-misdiagnosis-claims-scotland	cancer misdiagnosis	Keep only with verified expertise; parent medical
cycling-accident-claims-scotland	cycling accident	Keep; parent RTA
motorcycle-accident-claims-scotland	motorcycle accident	Keep; parent RTA
no-win-no-fee-scotland-explained	funding explained	Merge/301 to funding pillar

If more guides exist after the inspected excerpt, apply the same rule: one primary intent, one canonical owner, and no service-page duplicate.

Query groups to target within existing pages

- **Commercial:** accident claims Scotland; personal injury claims/solicitors Scotland; RTA, work, public place, clinical negligence, serious injury, industrial disease and CICA claims Scotland.
- **Eligibility:** can I claim; partly at fault; employer/council/public authority; child; cross-border; delayed diagnosis.
- **Evidence/process:** accident report, witness/CCTV, medical records/report/examination, liability denied, settlement, court attendance.
- **Funding:** no win no fee Scotland; deductions; success fee; outlays; insurance; who pays.
- **Compensation:** solatium; loss of earnings; care/treatment/travel/future needs; how valuation works. Do not publish a calculator until its methodology, sources and limitations are legally reviewed.

- **Conversational/AI:** “What happens after I contact a Scottish personal injury solicitor?”, “Does contacting a solicitor stop the three-year clock?”, “Is CICA the same as suing the attacker?”, “Can a Scottish court allow a late personal-injury action?”

5. AI search and answer-engine audit

Current assessment

Core answers are extractable because the pages render meaningful text without interaction and use question headings, answer boxes and lists. That is a sound foundation for Google AI Overviews, Bing/Copilot, ChatGPT search, Perplexity, Gemini and other retrieval systems.

The entity layer is unusable, however. The site asks systems to connect [LAW FIRM NAME], Accident Claims Scotland, a placeholder address and an unverified LegalService. There are no real people, reviewer credentials, regulator profiles, consistent external identities or source citations. This makes confident citation unsafe. Commodity wording and repetitive location pages provide little reason for an answer engine to cite this domain over primary sources or established Scottish firms.

Specific improvements

11. Put a verified entity panel on every page: “This website is operated by X. Legal services are provided by Y, a Scottish solicitor practice regulated by Z, membership number N. Enquiries go to Y / are referred to Y under [plain explanation].”
12. Give every legal article a named Scottish solicitor author or reviewer, profile URL, relevant accreditation/experience, datePublished, dateModified, review scope and citations.
13. Write 40–80 word answer blocks that state the general rule, the important qualification and the next safe step.
14. Link legal claims inline to legislation/GOV.UK/SCTS/HSE/NHS/ICO sources.
15. Separate civil negligence, CICA, employment/benefits, statutory disease schemes and complaints routes in comparison tables.
16. Publish original material only when verifiable: anonymised case methodology, evidence checklists, process timelines, expert interviews or aggregated first-party questions. Do not invent results.
17. Maintain stable terminology and IDs across visible copy and JSON-LD.
18. Make authorship, editorial policy and corrections process crawlable.

Useful comparison block

Route	Who decides/pays	Core test	Typical deadline warning	Key source
Civil personal-injury claim	Negotiated with defender/insurer or determined by a Scottish court	Fault/duty, breach, causation and loss	Court proceedings generally must be raised within the applicable limitation period	1973 Act; SCTS
CICA application	Criminal Injuries Compensation Authority	Eligibility under the 2012 Scheme; tariff and evidence rules	Adult applications normally within two years, subject to limited exceptions	GOV.UK/CICA
Workplace safety	HSE/local authority as	Possible safety-law	Not a substitute for a	HSE

Route	Who decides/pays	Core test	Typical deadline warning	Key source
complaint	regulator	breach	damages claim	
NHS complaint	Relevant NHS board/ombudsman route	Service/complaint standards	Not the same as a damages action and does not necessarily protect limitation	NHS Scotland/SPSO

6. Content gaps and actions

Review and consolidate before creating anything.

Page/action	URL	Intent	Proposed H2 structure	Gap evidence	Priority/legal review
Expand core eligibility	Existing PI pillar	eligibility for Scottish PI claim	What a claim is; elements; who may claim; shared fault; evidence; special cases; next step	Current direct answer is too categorical	High; solicitor
Expand funding with actual terms	Existing NWNF pillar	costs/deductions	Agreement used; if lose; if win; success fee; VAT; outlays; insurance; termination; examples; questions to ask	Provider terms absent	Critical; solicitor/compliance
Expand limitation	Existing limitation pillar	three-year rule/date of knowledge	s17; knowledge facts; children; death; incapacity; disease; clinical negligence; s19A; CICA/cross-border exclusions	Current summaries conflate "make/start claim" with raising proceedings	Critical; solicitor
Add "who handles your enquiry"	About + contact, not a new thin URL	provider/referral model	Operator; recipient; legal provider; regulator; data sharing; acceptance; complaints	Entity cannot be identified	Critical; compliance
Add medical assessment guide	Existing process/evidence page or one guide	do I need a medical examination	Why; who instructs; independence; records; attendance; report; privacy; disputed findings	Explicit user intent not fully owned	Medium; solicitor + clinician review

Page/action	URL	Intent	Proposed H2 structure	Gap evidence	Priority/legal review
Add child claimant section	Existing PI + limitation pages	child personal injury claim Scotland	Who can act; limitation; settlement/court safeguards; capacity/turning 16; advice	Important special case	High; solicitor
Add cross-border section	Existing PI/process page	accident outside Scotland / non-Scottish parties	Applicable law/jurisdiction; travel/package/product routes; shorter limits; urgent advice	Current Scotland-wide assertion lacks boundary	High; specialist review
Strengthen fatal claims	Existing guide; new pillar only if truly offered	fatal accident claims Scotland	Who may claim; estate/deceased claim; relatives; financial dependency; evidence; inquests/FAI distinction; limitation	Current serious-injury paragraph is too compressed	High; specialist
Editorial policy	About sub-section or /editorial-policy only if substantive	how legal content is produced	Authors; review cadence; sources; corrections; AI use; conflicts	Needed for YMYL trust	Medium; compliance

Do not create

- Ten more town pages or neighbourhood pages.
- “Solicitors near me” doorway pages.
- Separate thin pages for every synonym of accident claim/compensation lawyer.
- A second limitation, no-win-no-fee, RTA, work-accident or compensation overview.
- “Average payout” pages or calculators without current, Scottish-relevant methodology and solicitor sign-off.
- Office pages without genuine staffed locations.
- Case-result or testimonial pages without auditable evidence, consent and qualifications.

7. Topical authority and internal-link plan

Cluster	Pillar	Supporting pages	Natural anchors	Commercial value / merge controls
Core PI	/personal-injury-claims-scotland	eligibility, evidence, shared fault, denied liability, court	“evidence for a Scottish injury claim”, “if fault is shared”	Highest; homepage remains brand/commercial gateway, not a duplicate

Cluster	Pillar	Supporting pages	Natural anchors	Commercial value / merge controls
Process/funding/compensation	process, funding, compensation and limitation pillars	medical exam, evidence, court, valuation	"three-year limitation framework", "how funding deductions work"	High; merge overview guides into pillars
Road traffic	RTA pillar	whiplash, cycling, motorcycle; future pedestrian/MIB only if substantive	"road-traffic claim evidence", "uninsured driver claims"	High; redirect duplicate RTA guide
Work	work pillar	construction, offshore; future employer reassurance section	"accident at work claim", "preserve workplace evidence"	High; merge duplicate overview
Public place	public-place pillar	slip/trip, supermarket, council pavement	"occupiers' liability claim", "council road-defect evidence"	Medium/high; distinguish occupier vs roads authority
Medical	medical pillar	proof, NHS, GP, birth, prescription, cancer, care home	"breach and causation in clinical negligence"	High but highest YMYL review burden
Serious/fatal	serious pillar	rehabilitation, fatal guide	"future-care evidence", "relatives' claims after a death"	High; no injury micro-pages without depth
Industrial disease	industrial pillar	asbestos, NIHL, HAVS, delayed symptoms	"date of knowledge in disease claims"	High; cite disease/statutory scheme distinctions
CICA	CICA pillar	one reviewed guide only if a distinct sub-intent appears	"CICA's two-year application rule"	Medium; isolate from civil three-year messaging
Location	one Scotland service-area hub initially	at most verified high-value city pages	"serving people across Scotland"	Medium; no exact-match footer spam

Linking rules

- Every guide links once near the first relevant decision point to its pillar, once to limitation when time-sensitive, once to funding where relevant and once to contact with a descriptive non-pressuring CTA.
- Pillars link to 3–6 genuinely useful guides, not every article.
- Breadcrumbs: Home → Claim type/Guides → Article. City pages: Home → Areas served → City, if an areas hub exists.
- Vary anchors naturally; avoid sitewide exact-match city anchors.
- Add automated orphan checking to CI and maintain one content registry for URL, parent, primary intent, author, reviewer and dates.

8. On-page, trust and conversion review

Above the fold

Current H1 and proposition are keyword-clear but unsupported. Replace with a factual formulation after provider verification:

Personal injury claims in Scotland, handled by [verified firm].

Speak to a Scottish personal-injury team about whether a civil claim or another route may apply. An initial enquiry does not guarantee that your case will be accepted.

Directly below:

Accident Claims Scotland is [trading style/website] operated by [legal entity]. Legal services are provided by [firm], regulated by [regulator] under membership number [verified number]. [Explain referral relationship, if any.]

Form

- Ask only the minimum needed initially: name, one contact method, broad claim category, date and short description.
- Explain who receives the data before the submit button.
- Offer phone, email and accessible callback options, but only real monitored channels.
- Do not promise “confidential” until data flows/processors/security are documented.
- State a realistic response window and what to do if a limitation date is close. Make clear that submitting the form does not stop a time limit and does not create a solicitor-client relationship.
- Preserve entered values when validation/delivery fails.
- Confirmation must provide a reference and be sent only after durable acceptance.

Suggested acknowledgement:

We have received your enquiry (reference [ID]). It will be reviewed by [verified recipient]. We aim to contact you within [verified period]. Sending this form does not mean that a solicitor has accepted your case and does not stop any legal time limit. If a deadline may be close, seek urgent independent advice.

Claims requiring evidence or amendment

Remove or prove:

- “Regulated by the Law Society of Scotland”
- “our Scottish solicitors”
- “regulated Scottish practice”
- “solicitor-led claims/service”
- every “we handle” claim type
- “no win, no fee available”
- “no obligation” and “confidential” operational promises
- office/location coverage claims
- author/reviewer and date assertions
- implied expertise in offshore, birth injury, cancer, asbestos and catastrophic injury

Legally qualify:

- “accident was not your fault” (shared fault can still be relevant).

- “within the last three years” (not the complete statutory test; proceedings generally need to be raised in time).
- “missing the deadline extinguishes your right” (use careful limitation language; distinguish prescription).
- court discretion under section 19A (never imply extension is routine).
- compensation/time estimates.
- “you will not pay if unsuccessful” unless the actual agreement deals with outlays, insurance, termination, dishonesty/non-cooperation and adverse expenses.
- employer/job reassurance; do not promise no employment consequences.

9. Competitor review

The public search snapshot on 28 July 2026 surfaced these organic competitors. Rankings vary by location, device and personalisation; this is not a rank report.

Competitor	Visible strength	Weakness/opportunity	Practical lesson
Winn Solicitors (Scotland) LLP, winnscotland.com	Clear firm identity, contact details, service categories, process and partner network	Broad promotional statements need close qualification	Match entity clarity and exceed it with transparent funding and primary sources
Scotland Claims, scotlandclaims.co.uk	Strong “100% compensation” differentiation and callback journey	Aggressive guarantees/comparisons create evidential/compliance questions	Differentiate through balanced, verifiable explanation rather than superlatives
ACS Accident Claims Scotland, accidentclaimsscotland.co.uk	Exact-match brand history and focused PI categories	Potentially dated/generic presentation	Avoid brand confusion; make legal entity and domain unmistakable
Scottish Accident, scottishaccident.co.uk	Multilingual intake, clear registered/FCA identity, end-to-end accident-management proposition	Claims-management/referral model differs from a solicitor practice	State model as clearly; accessible multilingual service is a real differentiator if operationally supported
Stewart Legal, stewartlegal.co.uk	Named specialist/solicitor-advocate positioning, broad Scottish PI scope	Broad scope still requires deep topic support	Named expertise is more persuasive than anonymous “specialists”
Gildeas, gildeas.net	Recognised Scottish firm, Law Society-accredited specialist claim, guide assets	Some publisher material may be less structured for answers	Build verifiable expert profiles and accessible HTML guides
Slater and Gordon Scotland	Brand authority, detailed Scottish funding content	National brand may feel less locally specific	Win on precise Scots-law explanations and transparent local responsibility
SCTS/GOV.UK/HSE/NHS/legislation.gov.uk	Primary authority and high citation trust	Not commercial or personalised	Cite them; add plain-English decision support they do not provide

Backlink strength, traffic and conversion cannot be inferred from SERPs. Use licensed backlink data and analytics before claiming a gap.

10. Legal accuracy and authoritative-source review

Limitation

The key source is the Prescription and Limitation (Scotland) Act 1973 — <https://www.legislation.gov.uk/ukpga/1973/52/contents>. The site should explain that section 17 generally bars an action for personal injuries unless proceedings are brought within the statutory period calculated under the section, including the relevant date-of-knowledge provisions. It should identify the statutory knowledge facts accurately, not reduce them to “discovering negligence”. Section 19A gives the court equitable discretion to allow an otherwise time-barred personal-injury action, but exercise is case-specific and never guaranteed. Children, incapacity, death, disease, abuse, product liability, accidents abroad and CICA require separate analysis.

Use “limitation” for the personal-injury triennium and avoid casually calling it a “prescriptive period”. Most importantly, **contacting a solicitor or submitting this form is not the same as raising court proceedings**.

CICA

The official CICA guide — <https://www.gov.uk/guidance/criminal-injuries-compensation-a-guide> says adult applications should normally be made as soon as reasonably practicable and not later than two years after the incident, with distinct provisions for applicants who were under 18 and limited extension conditions. Eligibility and awards come from the 2012 Scheme/tariff. This is not an ordinary negligence action and must not inherit the sitewide three-year wording.

Court process

The Scottish Courts and Tribunals Service National Personal Injury Court page — <https://scotcourts.gov.uk/courts-and-tribunals/sheriff-and-justice-of-the-peace-courts/national-personal-injury-court/> confirms an all-Scotland specialist sheriff court. Do not imply every claim is brought there or that the user will never attend court. Explain that forum/procedure depends on the case and that many claims settle without a proof/trial.

Funding

The site must publish the actual Scottish funding arrangement, not a generic “no win no fee” slogan. Have a Scottish solicitor check the Civil Litigation (Expenses and Group Proceedings) (Scotland) Act 2018 framework and applicable success-fee regulations/current professional guidance. Explain:

- what agreement the client signs;
- whether the percentage includes VAT;
- which damages form the calculation base and any statutory cap;
- treatment of future damages;
- outlays and after-the-event insurance;
- adverse expenses/QOCS limits and exceptions;
- early termination, rejection of advice, dishonesty or non-cooperation;
- who receives recovered judicial expenses.

Privacy/marketing

The enquiry is likely to contain health information. The controller/processor/referral chain, lawful basis, special-category condition, retention, international transfers and data-subject rights need specific review. Cookie consent is required before non-essential storage/access under PECR; a static cookie policy is not a

consent mechanism. Claims-management marketing may also engage FCA rules depending on the operator/model. See the ICO cookies guidance — <https://ico.org.uk/for-organisations/direct-marketing-and-privacy-and-electronic-communications/guide-to-pecr/cookies-and-similar-technologies/> and ASA/CAP claims-management guidance — <https://www.asa.org.uk/advice-online/litigation-claims-management.html>.

11. Schema plan

Use after verification

- Sitewide: Organization (or LegalService only when the operator really is the regulated provider), WebSite.
- Service page: WebPage + Service, isPartOf, provider pointing to one verified organisation ID.
- Article: Article with real Person author/reviewer, actual dates and publisher.
- Breadcrumbs: BreadcrumbList.
- FAQs: FAQPage only for visible, non-repetitive questions; do not expect Google rich results.
- City page: WebPage/Service.areaServed; no LocalBusiness or local address unless a genuine location operates there.

Verified-value template

```
`json
{
  "@context": "https://schema.org",
  "@graph": [
    {
      "@type": "Organization",
      "@id": "https://www.accident-claims-scotland.com/#organization",
      "name": "REPLACE WITH VERIFIED LEGAL NAME",
      "alternateName": "Accident Claims Scotland",
      "url": "https://www.accident-claims-scotland.com/",
      "telephone": "REPLACE WITH VERIFIED VALUE",
      "email": "REPLACE WITH VERIFIED VALUE",
      "address": {
        "@type": "PostalAddress",
        "streetAddress": "REPLACE WITH VERIFIED VALUE",
        "addressLocality": "REPLACE WITH VERIFIED VALUE",
        "postalCode": "REPLACE WITH VERIFIED VALUE",
        "addressCountry": "GB"
      },
      "sameAs": [
```



```

    "REPLACE WITH VERIFIED REGULATOR OR OFFICIAL PROFILE URL"
  ],
  {
    "@type": "WebSite",
    "@id": "https://www.accident-claims-scotland.com/#website",
    "url": "https://www.accident-claims-scotland.com/",
    "name": "Accident Claims Scotland",
    "publisher": {
      "@id": "https://www.accident-claims-scotland.com/#organization"
    }
  }
]
}

```

If the website operator and legal provider differ, model both as separate organisations and state the relationship visibly; do not collapse them into one entity.

12. Reusable AI-search-friendly answer blocks

These are editorial starting points, not approved legal text.

What is a personal-injury claim in Scotland?

A personal-injury claim is a civil claim seeking damages for injury and related loss caused by another person or organisation's legally actionable fault. A claimant generally needs evidence of fault, causation and loss. Different rules may apply to criminal injuries, workplace schemes, clinical negligence and cross-border cases. Source: Prescription and Limitation (Scotland) Act 1973 and specialist Scottish advice.

Can I make an accident claim in Scotland?

You may be able to claim if Scots law applies, another party was legally at fault, that fault caused injury and loss, and court proceedings can still be raised in time. Shared fault does not always prevent a claim, but may reduce damages. Eligibility depends on the facts and evidence.

Who may be eligible?

An injured adult, a child acting through an appropriate representative, or in some circumstances relatives or an executor after a death may have a claim. The correct claimant, procedure and time limit depend on the circumstances, so specialist advice is important.

What if I was partly at fault?

A claim may still be possible. Under contributory-negligence principles, damages can be reduced to reflect the claimant's share of responsibility. The percentage is evidence- and case-specific; it should not be predicted without examining the facts.

What is the personal-injury time limit in Scotland?

For many Scottish personal-injury actions, court proceedings generally must be raised within three years of the injury or a later statutory date of knowledge. The calculation and exceptions are fact-sensitive. Children, incapacity, death, disease, abuse, CICA and cross-border matters may differ. Contacting a solicitor alone does not raise proceedings. Source: 1973 Act, sections 17–19A.

What does date of knowledge mean?

Date of knowledge is a statutory concept used when relevant facts about the injury, its attribution and the defender were not known at the time. It is not automatically the date of diagnosis or the date someone was told “negligence occurred”. Actual and reasonably discoverable knowledge may matter. A Scottish solicitor should assess the evidence.

What evidence will I need?

Useful evidence can include medical records, accident reports, photographs, CCTV, witness details, correspondence, employment records and proof of financial loss. The evidence needed varies by claim. Preserve it promptly and avoid changing or overstating what happened.

Will I need a medical examination?

Often, medical evidence is needed to connect the accident with the injury and assess prognosis. A solicitor may arrange an independent examination by an appropriate expert. Whether one is needed, and what records are reviewed, depends on the claim.

How much compensation might be available?

There is no reliable figure without evidence. Scottish damages may include compensation for pain and suffering (often called solatium) and proved past or future financial losses such as earnings, care, treatment or travel. Severity, prognosis, causation and evidence all affect value.

What losses can be included?

Depending on the case, damages may cover solatium, lost earnings, care and assistance, treatment, travel, equipment, accommodation and future needs. Every item must be legally recoverable, caused by the wrong and supported by evidence; double recovery is not allowed.

How long can a claim take?

There is no fixed duration. A straightforward admitted-liability claim may resolve sooner than a serious-injury, clinical-negligence or disputed-liability case. Treatment, prognosis, expert evidence and court procedure can all affect timing. Do not settle before the evidence allows a responsible valuation.

Will I have to go to court?

Many claims settle without a proof or trial, but court proceedings may be needed to protect a time limit or resolve liability/value. Starting proceedings does not necessarily mean a final hearing. Your solicitor should explain the forum, risks and whether attendance may be required. Source: SCTS.

How does no win no fee work in Scotland?

“No win no fee” is a general label, not a complete price. The written agreement should explain what happens if the claim wins or loses, any success fee or deduction, VAT, outlays, insurance, adverse-expense risk and termination. Terms vary, so read the actual agreement before signing.

Could fees or deductions apply?

Yes, depending on the agreement. A success fee, VAT, insurance premium or unrecovered outlay may be relevant, while statutory caps and special treatment may apply to parts of damages. The provider should give a worked explanation based on its verified terms.

Can I claim against my employer without losing my job?

An employee may have a civil claim where an employer’s breach caused injury, and employers commonly carry liability insurance. Employment consequences cannot be guaranteed. Keep records, obtain advice and raise any retaliation or dismissal concern with an employment-law specialist.

Can a child make a claim?

Potentially, yes, through the appropriate adult procedure. Scottish limitation and court safeguards for children differ from the standard adult position. Because age, capacity and settlement approval affect the route, seek Scottish advice promptly rather than waiting.

How does CICA differ from a civil claim?

CICA applies the Criminal Injuries Compensation Scheme and tariff; it is not a negligence action and the offender does not need to be sued. Adult applications are normally subject to a two-year rule, with limited exceptions. A civil claim may sometimes exist separately. Source: GOV.UK/CICA.

What happens after I make an enquiry?

The recipient should confirm who has received the information, check urgency and conflicts, assess whether the matter is within scope, and explain funding and next steps. An enquiry is not the same as case acceptance and does not stop a time limit. The current website must not use this block until its form actually delivers enquiries.

13. 30/60/90-day implementation plan

First 72 hours

- Disable or unpublish the public form and unsupported claims.
- Remove placeholder JSON-LD and local-business markup.
- Decide whether to place the whole domain behind a maintenance/noindex response.
- Preserve logs and investigate whether anyone has used the simulated form.
- Establish real ownership, controller and legal-provider facts.

Days 1–30

- Implement/test secure enquiry delivery and operational response.
- Replace all placeholders and create verified About, Contact, Privacy, Cookies, Terms and Complaints content.
- Complete solicitor review of homepage, PI, limitation, funding and CICA pages first.
- Remove/noindex thin city pages.
- Fix lint and create CI release gates.

- Create one content registry and merge duplicate intents with single-hop 301s.

Days 31–60

- Review remaining service pages and highest-value guides.
- Add expert profiles, citations, real dates and editorial policy.
- Add measured analytics/consent and connect GSC/Bing.
- Run accessibility testing with keyboard, screen reader, 200%/400% zoom and mobile devices.
- Establish CWV baseline and fix template-level issues.

Days 61–90

- Relaunch only after compliance sign-off and end-to-end form tests.
- Submit clean sitemap; request recrawl for priority pages.
- Begin evidence-led digital PR and expert commentary, not bulk link building.
- Use real query/conversion data to decide which city pages and new guides deserve investment.
- Review qualified-enquiry rate, not raw form volume.

Final conclusion

The site's information architecture is substantially better than a typical thin exact-match lead-generation site, and it could become a useful Scottish personal-injury resource. Its present public implementation, however, creates a severe mismatch between appearance and reality. The launch gate is not "more SEO content"; it is verified identity, lawful and truthful operation, real enquiry delivery, accountable Scottish legal review and removal of fabricated placeholder signals. Only after those are fixed should indexation, local expansion, AI visibility and conversion optimisation proceed.